



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

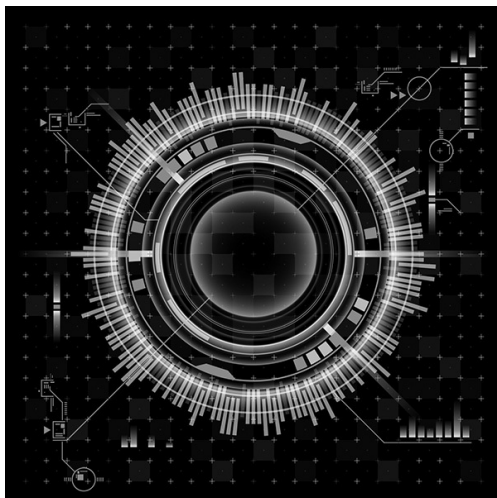
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Let's Start!

Where is technology headed? What does the future hold?



Learning Outcome

Accurately use information about common technology in communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- Do you feel that we spend too much time on our electronic devices? Why or why not?
- Do you think that technology will help solve problems like diseases? Which problems?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about technology.
- I can ask for clarification or use rhetorical questions to emphasize a point.
- I can talk about future action.





Let's Explore!

Mr. Anderson believes that **AI*** will change the world for the better.

* "AI" is short for artificial intelligence. It is a popular subject of science fiction books and movies.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Sally: Mr. Anderson, can you tell us where the future of technology is headed? In your opinion, what is the biggest technological challenge that we are going to face in the next five years?

Mr. Anderson: I believe that we have reached a point where computers and other electronic devices are able to complete the many daily tasks that we do at work. Artificial intelligence has improved exponentially in the past decade. I think it is going to surpass the thinking capacity of the human mind in the next five years.

Sally: Does this thought scare you? Do you think that we should feel threatened by how smart our devices are?

Mr. Anderson: That's a good question. I don't believe that the danger lies in the machines per se, but in the use that we are going to make of them from now on. With the processing power that we possess, diseases such as cancer or diabetes will be a thing of the past.

Sally: Don't you think this sounds too optimistic?

Mr. Anderson: Not at all. I'm starting a computer project with a team of doctors next month. Their research looks promising. We expect good results by the end of the year. I strongly believe that we will defeat cancer by 2050.

Sally: Let's hope so!



Instructions: Read the sentences below and circle the grammar mistakes.

1. Computers and other electronic devices can to complete the many daily tasks that we do at work.
2. Artificial intelligence has improve exponentially in the past decade.
3. I dont' believe that the danger lies in the machines per se.
4. With the processing power that we possess, we are going to can cure diseases such as cancer or diabetes.



Instructions: Choose the correct option to correctly complete the sentence.

- Can you tell us _____ the future of technology is headed?
a. where b. what c. when
- In your opinion, _____ is the biggest technological challenge that we are going to face in the next five years?
a. when b. how c. what
- Does this _____ scare you?
a. though b. think c. thought
- Do you _____ that we should feel threatened by how smart our devices are?
a. though b. thought c. think
- _____ think this sounds too optimistic?
a. Don't you not b. Do you don't c. Don't you





Extension Activity

Write a column in a newspaper about new technologies.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Imagine you are a journalist writing about new technologies. Write a newspaper column of 10 - 14 lines.
- Give your opinion on new technologies, using your experience and thoughts about the future.
- Imagine what the future of technology will be like in the next 5 years and then in 20 years.
- Use Future tenses (*will* and *going to*).
- Read your column aloud.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I write about new technologies.

☐ ☐

I talk about future actions and ideas.

☐ ☐

I identify new ways to discuss technology with my partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **artificial intelligence** (noun): computer systems able to perform tasks that normally require human intelligence
e.g. With artificial intelligence, computers are able to complete what we normally do at work.
- **exponentially** (adverb): at a rate that increases quickly by large amounts
e.g. Artificial intelligence has improved exponentially in recent years.
- **decade** (noun): a period of ten years
e.g. Artificial intelligence has improved exponentially in the past decade.
- **to surpass** (verb): to be better or greater than someone or something
e.g. Artificial intelligence is going to surpass the thinking capacity of the human mind in the next five years.
- **per se** (expression): as such
e.g. I don't believe that the danger lies in the machines per se.
- **processing power** (noun): the ability of a computer to perform operations
e.g. We can use the processing power that we possess to cure diseases.
- **a thing of the past** (expression): something that is not relevant anymore; outdated
e.g. Diseases such as cancer or diabetes will be a thing of the past.
- **to defeat** (verb): to beat; to vanquish
e.g. I strongly believe that we will defeat cancer by 2050.





Learning Points

Questions Within Sentences

You ask for clarification when you want more details of what the other person is talking about.

We often ask for clarification when we are not clear on what the other person is referring to. We ask the other person to be more specific by giving more information.

You can use questions with sentences to ask for clarification. You ask a question including a sentence within the question, like *Don't you think it sounds a bit too intense?*

Questions with sentences are called **embedded questions**.

You can use **embedded questions**, like *Can you tell me ... ?* or *Do you know if/which/what ... ?* to ask for clarification.

Look at the chart below for an explanation on how to make embedded questions.

Main Question	Embedded Question
Do you know ...	what/where/when/who ... ?
Do you remember ...	what/where/when/who ... ?
Can you tell me ...	what/where/when/who ... ?
Could you tell me ...	what/where/when/who ... ?

Examples:

- *Can you tell us where the future of technology is headed? (question with sentence)*
- *Do you think that we should feel threatened by how smart our devices are? (asking for clarification)*





Learning Points

Talking About the Future

You can use four different tenses to talk about the future.

- When you talk about things that are not decided or when you make a decision at the moment of speaking for the future, you use the modal verb *will*.
- When you ask about intentions, you use *going to*.
- When you talk about things that are arranged, on the agenda or booked for the future, you use the Present Continuous tense.
- When you talk about schedules or timetables in the future, you use the Simple Present tense.

Verb Tense	Example
Future Tense (Will)	<i>Diseases such as cancer or diabetes will be a thing of the past.</i>
Going to	<i>Computers are going to surpass the thinking capacity of the human mind in the next five years.</i>
Present Continuous Tense	<i>I'm starting a computer project with a team of doctors next month.</i>
Simple Present Tense	<i>We expect good results by the end of the year.</i>

